WEDNESDAY
March 16, 2005

# Oakland Tribune

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Guards also key to state title hopes for Highlanders **SPORTS**

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**IGER OFFERS OLIVE BRANCH**
Future Disney CEO reaches out to Pixar **BUSINESS inside Sports**

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A BODY'S BURDEN: OUR CHEMICAL LEGACY

# DuPont, 3M to cut nonstick chemical

■ Companies will reduce possible carcinogen PFOA at end of 2006

**By Douglas Fischer**
STAFF WRITER

DuPont and 3M, makers of Teflon and Scotchgard, will remove a key ingredient used to make nonstick and stain-resistant products that also contaminates our bodies and the global environment.

The move away from the chemical, known as PFOA, affects just a small fraction of DuPont's and 3M's business and won't take effect until the end of 2006. The compound, being studied by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency as a potential carcinogen, will still be used in other consumer and industrial products.

"It's a small part of our sales," DuPont spokesman R. Clifton Webb said Tuesday. "We're taking this step not because of any concerns about health, but certainly because of the perception of PFOA in the environment."

PFOA, or perfluorooctanoic acid, is found in almost all our

Please see **TEFLON,** News 9

**INSIDE:** Eating vegan may mean consuming less PBDEs. **Food**

**More information,** including a 35-question quiz to help you assess your potential "body burden," is available at www.insidebayarea.com/bodyburden

DOUGLAS FISCHER — Staff

**BILL FRIES,** a DuPont lab technician, checks a Teflon-coated pan undergoing a scratch test in the company's test kitchen in Wilmington, Del., in the fall.

# Ex-WorldCom chief found guilty of fraud

LOUIS LANZANO — Associated Press

**BERNARD EBBERS,** former CEO of WorldCom, exits Manhattan federal court Tuesday with his wife, Kristie. Ebbers was convicted on all counts in the trial in which he was accused of orchestrating an accounting scandal that bankrupted the once-giant telecommunications company.

## Ebbers could get 30-to-life in prison

**By Ken Belson**
NEW YORK TIMES

NEW YORK — Bernard Ebbers, the former chief executive of WorldCom, was found guilty Tuesday in federal court of orchestrating a record $11 billion fraud that came to symbolize the telecommunications bubble of the 1990s and the excesses that were uncovered in its aftermath.

The seven women and five men in the jury reached a verdict after deliberating for about 40 hours over eight days.

Ebbers was convicted of securities fraud, conspiracy and seven counts of filing false reports with regulators. The various counts

Please see **EBBERS,** News 9

**AT A GLANCE**

**THE DECISION:** After eight days of deliberation, a federal jury convicted Bernard Ebbers for his role in the WorldCom accounting fraud case.

**THE CONVICTIONS:**
- One count of securities fraud
- One count of conspiracy
- Seven counts of false regulatory filings

**WHAT'S NEXT:** The sentencing date is set for June 13, although the defense plans to appeal. Federal sentencing guidelines suggest 30 years to life in prison.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

# Schools bring up ranks' rear

■ Despite some progress, nearly half in Oakland district among the bottom 10 percent on state API

**By Alex Katz and Jill Tucker**
STAFF WRITERS

OAKLAND — Five years after the state started ranking all public schools on a 10-point scale, almost half of Oakland schools still rank at the very bottom, according to numbers released Tuesday.

Based on student scores on a battery of tests given last spring, almost half of city schools got a rank of 1, which is the lowest mark on the state's ranking system, called the Academic Performance Index.

That seems like bad news for parents, teachers and real estate agents, who might find it more difficult to sell homes next to "1" schools.

However, the numbers also show that most Oakland schools, like schools across the state, are making moderate to considerable progress on the annual state tests. And some have even managed to move up a few rungs on the API, which is a hard thing for a school to do when most of its competitors also are increasing their scores every year.

In Alameda, Edison Elementary not only earned a 10 on the statewide ranking — placing it among California's best schools — it also ranked 10 among these top performers.

Collectively, Alameda schools have steadily made progress toward meeting and exceeding state academic standards since the state began collecting the data six years ago.

Miller Elementary, a small

Please see **API,** News 9

**"We work really hard. We really are a family here. We do try to take care of each other."**

**Onaida Lerma**
FIFTH-GRADE TEACHER AT FRANKLIN ELEMENTARY

# CSU freshmen still short on the basics

■ More than half need remedial math, English, but university confident in new assessment system

**By Michelle Maitre**
STAFF WRITER

More than half the freshmen entering California State University system continue to need remedial help in math, English or both, according to a new report.

According to a report presented Tuesday to CSU's governing Board of Trustees, only 43 percent of the freshmen who entered in fall 2004 were fully proficient in both mathematics and English. The remaining students needed extra help in one or both subjects — and their numbers were virtually unchanged from the previous year.

According to the report, the freshmen who entered needing extra help in math — 37 percent — was identical to the number who needed extra help in the

Please see **CSU,** News 9

**BY THE NUMBERS**

How Cal State East Bay fared:

| Year | Subject | Percent needing help |
|---|---|---|
| Fall 2004 | Math | 51% |
| | English | 63% |
| Fall 2003 | Math | 43% |
| | English | 62% |

# Soldiers' films bring violence, gore home

■ Personal videos by troops in Iraq reveal all the horrors of war — with an MTV-ready soundtrack

**By Louise Roug**
LOS ANGELES TIMES

BAQOUBA, Iraq — When Pfc. Chase McCollough went home on leave in November, he brought a movie made by fellow soldiers in Iraq.

On his first night back at his parents' house in Texas, he showed the video to his fiancee, family and friends.

This is what they saw: a handful of American soldiers filmed through the green haze of night-vision goggles. Radio communication between two soldiers crackles in the background before it's drowned out by a heavy-metal sound track.

Please see **FILM,** News 9

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**Forecast**
Partly cloudy
Highs: mid-60s
Lows: upper 40s

Details on Living 10

# Death row cases under microscope

■ Ex-county prosecutor says Jews, black women were kept off capital juries

**By Dean E. Murphy**
NEW YORK TIMES

OAKLAND — The convictions of dozens of death row inmates in California are coming under legal scrutiny because of accusations that Jews and black women were excluded from juries in capital trials in Alameda County as "standard practice."

A former Alameda County prosecutor, John Quatman, made the claims in a sworn declaration filed in the habeas corpus case of Fred Freeman, a condemned inmate who is seeking to overturn his 1987 conviction in a killing and robbery at a Berkeley bar.

Quatman, who worked 26 years as a deputy district attorney and prosecuted the Freeman case, said the trial judge, Stanley Golde, advised him during jury selection that "no Jew would vote to send a defendant to the gas chamber."

"Judge Golde was only telling me what I already should have known to do," Quatman said in the declaration. "It was standard practice to exclude Jewish jurors in death cases."

Please see **DEATH,** News 9

**"It is highly likely that this is going to be a recurring problem for Alameda County cases, and it could show up elsewhere."**

**Nathan Barankin**
SPOKESMAN, STATE ATTORNEY GENERAL'S OFFICE